



Package development: The why, long-term maintenance and community building.

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- Why I developed my first package and continue to develop packages
- How I tackle long-term maintenance of my packages
- Community building around package development

Why start?



Personally:

- Supervisor told me to!!!!
- I enjoyed coding
- Thought it would be a cool thing to point to
- Combating negative thoughts

Why continue?

Altruistic reasons:

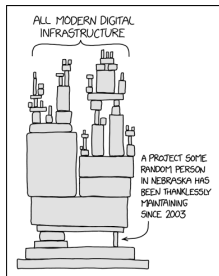
- Helps other people with their analysis problems!
- Contributes to the R community

Selfish reasons:

- Generates contacts for new research ideas!
- Gets me funding!
- Helps my international reputation
 - > 1000 citations on JStatSoft paper
 - > 1500 citations on methods paper
 - Editor-in-chief of JStatSoft
 - rOpenSci peer review standards board
 - ENBIS Young Statistician of the year 2019



- Only widely release what you are willing to maintain
- FEWEST DEPENDENCIES POSSIBLE!!!!!!
- Write code as simple as possible - don't do anything fancy!
 - changepoint has had 2 contacts from Brian Ripley in 11+ years!
- Succession planning.
- Communication between authors around expectations



Pigsy Ate Tripitaka
@ianholmes

You can download our code from the URL supplied.
Good luck downloading the only postdoc who can get
it to run, though [#overlyhonestmethods](#)

4:52 PM · Jan 8, 2013 · Twitter for iPhone

<https://xkcd.com/2347/>



For your code:

- Consider your motivations for building a new package
- Collaboration is hard! Be the one to reach out.

For the world:

- Tell others about your coding and software
- Breed positivity and honesty
- Don't paint unicorns
- Find your people

